KEEPING IT REAL

44%. THAT'S YOUR HOA BLIND SPOT.

Nearly half the homes for sale carry a monthly fee most quotes skip.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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IF YOU QUOTED A BUYER'S PAYMENT WITHOUT THE HOA, THE NUMBER WAS WRONG.

Realtor.com checked every home for sale in 2025. Almost half had a fee.

THE REAL MONTHLY COST IS HIGHER THAN THE NUMBER MOST BUYERS HEAR.

Realtor.com's Homeowners Association Report, released January 27, 2026: nearly 44% of homes for sale in 2025 carried a monthly HOA fee, up from 34.3% in 2019. For condos and townhomes specifically, it was 84.8%. The median fee among homes that have one reached $135 a month in 2025, up from $108 in 2019. None of that shows up in a payment estimate built on price and rate alone.

PUT THE HOA LINE IN EVERY ESTIMATE YOU SEND:

1 **Ask for the HOA fee before you quote a payment, not after.**
It's on the listing sheet or one call to the listing agent away.

2 **Assume a condo or townhome has one.**
84.8% do, so treat "no fee" as the exception to confirm, not the default to assume.

3 **Say the number out loud, not just in writing.**
A buyer who hears "plus $135 a month" before they fall for the house isn't surprised by it later.

4 **Re-check the fee at the final walkthrough.**
HOA dues move. The number you quoted at showing one isn't guaranteed at closing.

THE TAKEAWAY

QUOTE THE REAL NUMBER. ADD THE HOA LINE EVERY TIME.

A payment estimate that leaves out a fee isn't an estimate. It's a guess.

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